

Dear Branch Hiring Team,

I'm applying for the Senior AI DevOps & Reliability Engineer role. What drew me to this posting specifically is the "AI-first mentality" requirement — not as a buzzword, but as a real discipline I've already built into my own practice, alongside the CI/CD, Kubernetes, and infrastructure-as-code ownership the role calls for.

At Énergir, I introduced AI-assisted engineering practices into the team's tooling over the past several months: researching and applying hard scope gates and human-validation checkpoints before any AI-generated code reaches production, and flagging to leadership that the organization had no equivalent safeguards of its own. That's the same posture your posting describes — using tools like Claude Code to build frameworks and deliver automation, not just consume suggestions. Alongside that, I standardized CI/CD delivery for 12 application teams across nine distinct runtimes, led Azure cloud modernization with Terraform and Ansible IaC that eliminated configuration drift, and drove the root-cause analysis and automated remediation work that reduced MTTR across the application estate. At Desjardins, I built a Kubernetes/ArgoCD-driven provisioning system for on-demand Artifactory environments and a Python/FastAPI validation service that extended well past its original scope because I made the underlying logic reusable rather than one-off.

I want to be direct about where my background doesn't fully overlap with your stack: I haven't operated Kafka or other streaming infrastructure, and my production language experience is Python, Bash, C++, and Java rather than Go. My cloud depth is centered on Microsoft Azure, with real (if earlier-career and by-hand) hands-on AWS build experience from a client migration project at Tink — genuine exposure to the core services, not production operations at the scale this role implies. What I bring instead is a demonstrated pattern of learning unfamiliar platforms cold under a delivery deadline, across Salesforce, Kubernetes, and AWS itself, and turning a narrow ask into the more durable fix underneath it.

I'd welcome the chance to talk through how that experience applies to Branch's delivery platform. Thank you for your consideration.

Sincerely, Marc Berthelette